School of the
ARTS AND ARCHITECTURE : ART

February 4, 2026

As Area Head of Painting and Drawing in the UCLA Department of Art, I am pleased to nominate Roshini Agarwal for the Distinguished Teaching Award for Teaching Assistants. In this capacity, I oversee teaching assistant appointments and routinely review peer and student evaluations across the department. I also had the opportunity to observe Ms. Agarwal's teaching firsthand in Advanced Painting during a two-week period when the professor on record took a temporary medical leave of absence. It was this direct and sustained observation, combined with my broader oversight of her work as a teaching assistant, that prompted me to nominate her. I can state with confidence that Ms. Agarwal demonstrates an exemplary and consistent record of pedagogical excellence, grounded in current best practices in art education and marked by a deep commitment to student learning and academic success.

Ms. Agarwal has served as a teaching assistant in Advanced Printmaking (twice), Advanced Painting, and Advanced Drawing. Across these courses, she has distinguished herself through a student-centered teaching approach and an exceptional depth of technical and material knowledge. She consistently meets students at their individual points of development, offering guidance that is both rigorous and accessible, and thoughtfully tailored to support conceptual as well as technical growth. Her ability to clearly articulate complex processes and ideas allows advanced studio content to remain challenging while still approachable.

A defining strength of Ms. Agarwal's teaching is her commitment to fostering an inclusive and supportive studio environment. She prioritizes the classroom as a space built on trust, peer-to-peer engagement, and thoughtful group dynamics, enabling students to feel a strong sense of belonging and shared purpose. By cultivating an atmosphere that supports experimentation and risk-taking, she encourages students to push beyond their comfort zones and engage more deeply with their creative practice. This approach reflects best practices in student-centered and inclusive pedagogy and has a clear, positive impact on student confidence and participation.

During my direct observation of Ms. Agarwal's teaching in Advanced Painting, I was particularly struck by the clarity and depth of her instruction, as well as her responsiveness to student needs. Each student received individualized written feedback on their final project proposal; these notes were detailed, thoughtful, and thorough, demonstrating her careful attention to each student's goals and development. At a moment of transition and uncertainty for the course, Ms. Agarwal provided continuity, structure, and reassurance, ensuring that students remained focused, supported, and motivated.

Ms. Agarwal's excellence as a teaching assistant was further recognized through her appointment as an instructor in the School of Art's Summer Institute—an opportunity reserved for individuals who demonstrate both pedagogical strength and leadership in the classroom. In this role, she brought the same level of care, preparation, and intellectual rigor to her teaching, working with students at a formative stage in their artistic development. Her ability to adapt instruction to meet students where they are, while continuing to challenge them to think critically and creatively, underscores her versatility and effectiveness as an educator.

For these reasons, Roshini Agarwal exemplifies the values of the Distinguished Teaching Award for Teaching Assistants. Her sustained record of effective, inclusive, and inspiring teaching makes her an outstanding candidate for this recognition, and I offer my strongest endorsement of her nomination.

Respectfully,
Cosmo Whyte



Assistant Professor
Area Head of Painting
Department of Art
UCLA School of Arts and Architecture

Teaching is central to my identity as both an artist and an educator. As a Teaching Assistant in Advanced Printmaking, Advanced Painting, and Advanced Drawing, and as an instructor at the Summer Art Institute at UCLA, I supported students through individualized feedback, inclusive critique practices, and process-based assessment. Across these courses, my goal was to ground students in both technical and conceptual skills, fostering confidence, agency, and sustained engagement in their artistic practice. I prioritize cultivating the classroom as a safe and approachable space—one shaped by peer-to-peer relationships and strong group dynamics—where students feel a sense of belonging and are encouraged to grow through risk-taking.

During my time as a Teaching Assistant for Advanced Painting, the course underwent an unexpected transition when the professor took a leave of absence. In the two-week interim before a new instructor was appointed, I independently managed two class sessions. I organized class structure, tracked attendance and student progress, communicated essential information via email, and provided individualized feedback on student proposals for their final projects. This feedback was delivered through detailed written notes followed by one-on-one meetings, where I emphasized adapting to the evolving conditions of the course while addressing each student's conceptual goals and challenges. By maintaining continuity during a moment of uncertainty, I was able to provide students with stability and reassurance, strengthening our working relationships and reinforcing trust in the learning environment. This experience sharpened my ability to take initiative and adapt to change, and directly informed my confidence in leading my own painting course at the Summer Art Institute in Summer 2025.

One-on-one feedback is a core component of my teaching practice. I approach these conversations as collaborative problem-solving sessions, asking guiding questions, listening closely to students' intentions, and helping them articulate their own goals. Rather than prescribing solutions, I emphasize reflection and iteration as essential tools within an evolving creative process. This approach supports students across varying skill levels and learning styles while reinforcing the idea that growth—not perfection—is central to artistic practice. This philosophy is clearly demonstrated in *Teaching Artefact #3*, an original color theory assignment I designed with two components: first, students identified and analyzed the structure of the color wheel; second, they reimagined the wheel based on their understanding. The assignment foregrounded iteration as a learning strategy and became foundational to the syllabus I developed for the Summer Art Institute course *(Teaching Artefact #5)*.

I also played an active role in leading critiques, which function as the primary site of active learning in advanced studio courses. I believe effective critiques must be student-centered and inclusive, as they can be intimidating and vulnerable experiences for artists. To foster constructive dialogue, I set clear expectations for respectful engagement, modeled supportive language, and ensured that all voices were heard. For younger students in the Summer Art Institute program, I introduced a "Critique Guide" *(Teaching Artefact #4)*, a step-by-step template that students completed and exchanged with one another. This tool helped structure

both written and oral feedback, framing critique as a shared meaning-making process while strengthening critical thinking and visual literacy. It also created multiple points of entry into participation, particularly benefiting students who were hesitant to speak aloud. Student evaluations consistently highlighted the importance of the critique and feedback process to their learning experience *(Teaching Artefact #1 & #2)*.

Throughout my teaching, I remain deeply committed to inclusive pedagogy. As an international student, I am acutely aware that students enter art studio courses and early college programs with diverse cultural backgrounds, artistic histories, and levels of confidence. I work intentionally to reflect this diversity in course materials, including art history slide presentations, and to validate a wide range of artistic approaches. I remain attentive to accessibility needs and make myself available beyond scheduled class time to offer additional support. I view mentorship as an essential component of teaching and actively support students navigating academic, creative, and professional concerns.

Across all courses, my aim has been not only to help students refine their artistic practice, but to trust and develop their individual voices as artists. My sustained success as a Teaching Assistant lies in my ability to balance rigor with empathy, structure with flexibility, and critical discourse with encouragement. I am honored to be nominated for this award and grateful for the opportunity to contribute meaningfully to student learning at UCLA.

I believe that teaching art is fundamentally about empowering students to think critically, work reflectively, and develop confidence in their creative voices. My teaching philosophy centers on student-centered learning, where feedback, dialogue, and process function as essential tools for growth. As a Teaching Assistant in advanced studio courses at UCLA, I worked to cultivate an inclusive learning environment that fosters experimentation, risk-taking, and sustained engagement.

At the core of my approach is the belief that learning happens through iteration. In studio-based education, outcomes are visible, but the thinking, revision, and struggle that lead to those outcomes are equally significant. I emphasize process-based learning by encouraging students to reflect on their decisions, articulate their intentions, and understand setbacks as generative moments rather than failures. A guiding principle in my teaching is the simple directive: *do it once, do it again—but differently*. This philosophy informs my feedback practices, ensuring that students are recognized and supported for effort, growth, and conceptual development, rather than solely for technical perfection or polished final results.

Feedback is the primary pedagogical tool in my teaching. I approach one-on-one feedback as a collaborative exchange in which listening is as important as responding. Rather than positioning myself as an authority delivering judgments, I ask open-ended questions that help students clarify their ideas, assess their choices, and make informed decisions about their work. I also introduce students to a wide range of artistic methodologies through examples from art history and contemporary practice, while directing them toward relevant resources. As the adage suggests, “Follow not the footsteps of your masters; seek what they sought.” This approach supports student autonomy and helps students build the confidence to evaluate their own work critically over time.

Group critiques are another central component of my teaching philosophy. I view critiques as spaces for shared inquiry, community building, and collective learning. To foster meaningful participation, I structure critiques to prioritize observation, interpretation, and reflection before evaluation or judgement. This framework helps students develop analytical and verbal skills while maintaining a respectful and supportive atmosphere. I am especially attentive to inclusivity in critique settings, inviting multiple forms of participation and ensuring that quieter or more reserved students are not overshadowed. I understand that critique can be intimidating at all stages of artistic development, I follow group discussions with one-on-one meetings to ensure students are fully supported and able to process feedback in ways that are productive for their individual practices.

Inclusivity is not an add-on to my teaching; it is a guiding principle. Students enter advanced studio courses with diverse backgrounds, identities, and levels of access to art education. I strive to acknowledge and support this diversity by validating multiple artistic perspectives and remaining flexible in my pedagogical approach. I am mindful of how power dynamics,

confidence, and prior training shape classroom participation, and I work to create an environment in which all students feel safe to take creative risks and contribute meaningfully.

My teaching philosophy was further shaped by periods of increased responsibility, including a time when I independently led Advanced Painting courses during a faculty transition. In this role, I supported students through uncertainty by maintaining clear communication, providing structured feedback on project proposals, and fostering consistency in classroom expectations. This experience reinforced my belief that teaching is also an act of care—one that requires stability, attentiveness, and responsiveness to students' evolving needs.

Ultimately, my goal as an educator is to help students develop skills that extend beyond the classroom: critical thinking, self-reflection, and the ability to engage thoughtfully with others. Teaching art is part of a long, largely oral tradition of artists passing down knowledge, experience, and ways of seeing. I want students to leave my courses not only with a deeper understanding of this history, but also with the ability to critically engage with it, question it and locate their own creative voices within it. Teaching, for me, is an ongoing practice of listening, adapting, and learning alongside my students, and more importantly of fostering a sense of belonging within the artistic community at UCLA.

Timestamp	Which class were you in this Session?	What was your primary reason for attending the Summer	On a scale of 1 to 5 how much did the Summer Art institute offering college credit influence your decision to	How did you hear about the UCLA Summer Art Institute?	Please rate the overall program on a scale of 1 – 5:	Did the exercises and assignments help you grow as an artist? Rate your artistic	Rate you experience in the Broad art center?	Technique (specific to your area of study):	Critiquing artwork:	Contemporary Art and Art History:	Documenting your artwork:	What did you enjoy or learn from the above artist lectures?	What was your favorite part about the program?	What was your least favorite part?	What would you change about the program?	Do you feel that your instructor was an effective educator? Why or why not?	Do you feel that your teaching assistant was an effective educator? Why or Why not?	: What aspects of your program were most useful?	Please share any additional comments about your experience at Summer Art Institute:	Would you recommend this program to others? Why or why not?
7/18/2025 12:47:03	Painting with Roshini	To experience UCLA		4 Friend	5	4	5 yes		yes	yes	yes	I enjoyed that I was able to learn how to apply art in the "real world" and possibly develop a career in the topic.	The community was very enriching and I am very grateful that I was able to learn with a group who was engaged and ready to participate.	The critiques were a struggle for me since I am quite shy, but I tried to participate and grow.	It would be nice to have had more materials (paper towels, tape etc.) since we ran out pretty quickly.	Yes she was amazing! I loved how she explained things and was able to keep us engaged throughout the program. I learned a lot about the art field and am very grateful for all of the energy she poured into the class. <3	Yes she was also amazing! She always helped and was there to offer her insight and feedback :)	The experience and working in a campus studio.	I enjoyed it very much	I would definitely! I think anyone who is interested in art and is looking to gain more experience should take it in a heartbeat.
7/18/2025 13:06:46	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		2 Friend	4	4	3 yes		yes	yes	yes	i enjoyed learning about how different artists got to where they are at the moment--that no one story is the same	meeting new people	not enough time for projects/constraints	adding more variety in the paint mediums	roshini is my goat i loved learning about different techniques and ways to paint	yes rachel is also my goat she's so funny and has a lot of great ideas	i think having the broad, but also specific prompts were very helpful	so fun	yes bc it's very fun
7/18/2025 13:09:48	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		3 Friend	4	3	4 yes		yes	yes	yes	I enjoyed learning about people's academic paths that brought them to their current job as an artist.	I felt pretty rushed and frustrated because of the time constraints and not being allowed to use oil paint.	The initial still life in acrylic on butcher paper	Maybe allowing a bit more freedom in terms of material and time.	Yes! Roshini made me feel totally comfortable speaking my mind and expressing my opinions in class. They helped me conceptually and technically with my art.	Yes! Rachel was super nice from the first day and I feel like she was easy to talk to. I enjoyed having her in the room as we painted and asking for her opinions on what I was doing.	Being in a classroom environment and being able to walk around the room and be inspired by and get feedback from my peers.		I would. Honestly, I was pretty frustrated at times and unsatisfied with the art I was making but I think that's an important experience to have to improve. I'm leaving this program really inspired.
7/18/2025 13:22:24	Painting with Roshini	To try something new		3 Search Engine	4	4	4 yes		yes	yes	yes	I learned that art can be very different	Drawing	Not drawing	I would make the syllabus correct	Yes, I think she gave excellent critique and helped me open up to new things	Yeah, she helped the teacher pretty well	The free tools?		Sure, pretty fun and helped me learn alot.
7/18/2025 13:24:06	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		4 Friend	5	5	5 yes		yes	yes	yes	I enjoyed learning new techniques and artists!	Making new art friend groups and making paintings with limited color palettes	walking up the hill from getting food	lack of supplies	YESSSS i learned new techniques and preferences	YES i learned their experiences and tricks to certain techniques	materials and instructors	I want to go to school here pls accept me!	YES
7/18/2025 13:24:45	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		2 Search Engine	5	5	5 yes		yes	yes	yes	I learned the process of the many different artists	My favorite part of the program was the communication between the teacher and student and getting advice	I thought that there wasn't many opportunity to learn from peers in other departments. Not a lot of collaboration between the different art departments	Probably make it longer if I could	I felt the instructor was an effective educator because despite their very different style, their knowledge went a long way in gearing us on the right path in our process	I do because they also showcased their knowledge in art history and art in general	The most useful aspect was probably the critiquing	I think there could have been more supplies. Lack of scissors and tape	I would because I feel I learned a lot
7/18/2025 13:24:45	Painting with Roshini	To try something new		4 Website	4	4	4 yes		yes	No	yes	Critiquing artwork	Painting	Short on all supplies	More supplies, we were short on types, colors, brushes and almost everything.	Yes, but we don't have a lot of time to paint	Yes, very helpful	Try new things	Short on a lot of supplies	Yes, great experience
7/18/2025 13:25:02	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		3 Search Engine	4	5	4 yes		yes	yes	yes	I enjoyed learning about the artist's experiences and how they found their style.	I enjoyed the artist community and bonding with other artists.	My least favorite part was running out of yellow paint and pallet paper.	I don't think I would change anything.	Yes. Roshini was very effective in pushing me to explore my own artistic horizons.	Yes. Rachel was very helpful and helped me put up my final project.	I enjoyed being with other artists and learning and growing with them.	I don't have any.	Yes. I would recommend this to other artists interested in exploring art.
7/18/2025 13:25:17	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		3 Search Engine	5	5	5 yes		yes	yes	yes	Hearing how real artist work in life	Making art for long periods of time	Runny out of supplies	Having a plastic palette	Yes. She help me walk through new techniques	Yes. When I couldn't talk to the instructor she help me out.			
7/18/2025 13:25:19	Painting with Roshini	To try something new		1 Friend	5	3	5 No		yes	yes	yes	Learning about how they built up their work to where they are now	People i met	Walking to get food	Maybe include more lectures about technique/have instructor teach more techniques. And provide more materials to students that would help in a painting environment.	Yes but I feel like we could've learned more on how to improve	Yes, very talkative and fun	Meeting people and exploring other artist's art	There was a lack of art supplies so we had to bring in some of out own materials (erasers, water cups, scissors, etc.)	Yes it was super fun
7/18/2025 13:27:49	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		3 Friend	4	4	4 yes		yes	yes	yes	How to make it as an artist in the real world	Getting a lot of time to focus on painting and having teachers come around to help me improve while I am working on a specific piece.	A lot of the time we needed tape, erasers, etc that we didn't have	I would have liked to been able to use oil paint and work on that skill set	Yeah she introduced me to a lot of new concepts and things I hadn't thought a lot about before.	Yes she gave me a lot of ideas and guidance on my paintings	Having instructors giving me advice on my paintings while I was working		Yeah its a great experience to be around other artists and create a body of work
7/18/2025 13:30:21	Painting with Roshini	To try something new		3 Friend	5	4	5 No		yes	yes	yes	I loved seeing each one of their works; everybody had such unique styles. I also learned about their journeys and experiences and how they developed as an artist.	The community.	That there was a lack of supplies.	More supplies (ex: tape, palette paper, etc.)	Roshini was a very effective educator; she always encouraged and uplifted us, and provided helpful tips.	Rachel was a very effective educator; she always made things fun and provided an engaging and comfortable workspace.	The program forced us to get out of our comfort zone and stopped us from procrastinating. I've never finished 4 whole paintings in 2 weeks before!	No comments, all great!	Yes; the program brings together like-minded students—I made so many friends here!
7/18/2025 13:49:21	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		3 Search Engine	4	4	4 yes		No	yes	No	I liked seeing art in the real world, seeing both the conceptual process as well as the physical application and how the fine art world functions (galleries, artist circles, studios, etc)	I loved how much studio time we had, and the freedom we were given to develop pieces truly special to us. I also enjoyed how long the break was because it was a nice respite from working so hard for so many hours per day.	Some VA lectures were a bit hard to follow/not super interesting to me because they were extremely focused on very esoteric concepts and confusing ideas rather than showing real process or artwork, if that makes sense. Also, I had a LOT of homework especially the last week, where I was staying up really late to finish or make progress on my paintings. In the end I think it all worked out, but i do think that the first few days could have been condensed so that we could have more time to focus on I finished works.	Considering I had so much homework (not really assigned, but because I had to finish my pieces), I would have really appreciated if classes started even 30 minutes layered (I know this is hard to change and doesn't work for everyone, but personally I needed a bit more sleep (especially as a commuter who doesn't live in the LA area normally) Another thing is that I feel like we had a slight lack of materials - for example, during the collage making session, we had two pairs of scissors for the whole class. Similarly, we ran out of palette paper very rapidly and had to get creative by using Saran Wrap on cardboard (which also ran out!!)	Yes, I learned a lot from Roshini and she was very encouraging, informative, and patient with all of us!! I liked her demonstrations and how she pushed us to speak up more, especially during critiques.	Yes, Rachel was a super cool presence and very fun to talk to! I loved seeing her artwork, and she taught us about new and unique artists :)	Dedicated time to paint - at home, sometimes I can be lazy and rarely have the motivation to complete a real painting, but this camp allowed me/pushed me to finish 4 works that I'm very proud of!		Yes, it was great to meet people and get a taste of what art school might be like! I loved the art kits we got and all the supplies we get to take home!
7/18/2025 14:00:58	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		4 Search Engine	5	5	4 yes		yes	yes	yes									
7/18/2025 22:49:24	Painting with Roshini	To improve my art skills		1 Search Engine	4	4	5 yes		yes	No	No	I enjoyed seeing their personal journeys as artists and how they alter their work accordingly	I loved being able to do something I loved in an environment with those who also appreciate it	We could only use acrylic paint	I would give us more time in class dedicated to our larger paintings and compositions so we don't stress over completing them each night	Yes, my instructor gave great advice about both technical and conceptual ideas geared towards my individual projects, so the program felt very personalized.	Yes! Our TA was a important voice in the classroom and often gave a new and intriguing perspective for improvement and advice.	We did a lot of observational work, which was an area I had wanted to improve.	I loved the freedom we were given as students to really experience UCLA.	It was a such a fun experience, the people, projects and environment all made the program a must.

R. AGARWAL
Evaluation of Instruction Program Report
24F: ART 140 STU 1: ADVANCED PRINTMAKNG
No. of responses = 1
Enrollment = 12
Response Rate = 8.33%

1. Background Information:

1.1) Year in School:

n=1

Freshman	0
Sophomore	0
Junior	0
Senior	1
Graduate	0
Other	0

1.2) UCLA GPA:

n=1

Below 2.0	0
2.0 - 2.49	0
2.5 - 2.99	0
3.0 - 3.49	0
3.5+	1
Not Established	0

1.3) Expected Grade:

n=1

A	1
B	0
C	0
D	0
F	0
P	0
NP	0
?	0

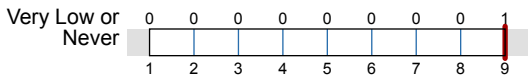
1.4) What requirements does this course fulfill?

n=1

Major	1
Related Field	0
G.E.	0
None	0

2. To What Extent Do You Feel That:

2.1) Teaching Assistant Knowledge – The T.A. was knowledgeable about the material.



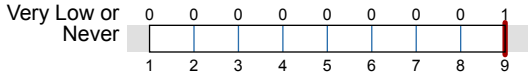
n=1
av.=9
md=9
dev.=0

2.2) Teaching Assistant Concern – The T. A. was concerned about student learning.



n=1
av.=9
md=9
dev.=0

2.3) Organization – Section presentations were well prepared and organized.



n=1
av.=9
md=9
dev.=0

2.4) Scope – The teaching assistant expanded on course ideas.



n=1
av.=9
md=9
dev.=0

2.5) Interaction – Students felt welcome in seeking help in or outside of the class.



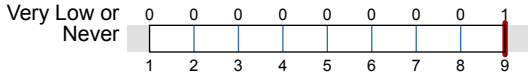
n=1
av.=9
md=9
dev.=0

2.6) Communication Skills – The teaching assistant had good communication skills.



n=1
av.=9
md=9
dev.=0

2.7) Value – The overall value of the sections justified your time and effort.



n=1
av.=9
md=9
dev.=0

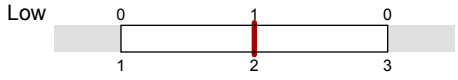
2.8) Overall – What is your overall rating of the teaching assistant?



n=1
av.=9
md=9
dev.=0

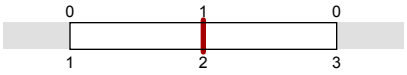
3. Your View of Section Characteristics:

3.1) Difficulty (relative to other courses)



n=1
av.=2
md=2
dev.=0

3.2) Workload/pace was

Too Slow  Too Much

n=1
av.=2
md=2
dev.=0

3.3) Integration of section with course was

Poor  Excellent

n=1
av.=3
md=3
dev.=0

3.4) Texts, required readings

Poor  Excellent

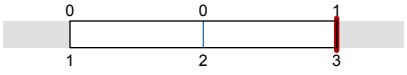
n=1
av.=3
md=3
dev.=0

3.5) Homework assignments

Poor  Excellent

n=1
av.=3
md=3
dev.=0

3.6) Graded materials, examinations

Poor  Excellent

n=1
av.=3
md=3
dev.=0

3.7) Lecture presentations

Poor  Excellent

n=1
av.=3
md=3
dev.=0

3.8) Class discussions

Poor  Excellent

n=1
av.=3
md=3
dev.=0

4. Comments:

4.1) Please identify what you perceive to be the real strengths and weaknesses of this teaching assistant and course.

- Roshini is one of my favorite TAs, and this was the second time I had the opportunity to have her as a TA. She was always there to help, even taking the time to host open studio sessions for us to complete our assignments. Any question we had, Roshini made sure we found the answer. It was also amazing to hear her talk about her work, and she was always very communicative about the schedule through emails.

Profile

Subunit: ART
Name of the instructor: R. AGARWAL
Name of the course: (Name of the survey) 24F: ART 140 STU 1: ADVANCED PRINTMAKNG

Values used in the profile line: Mean

2. To What Extent Do You Feel That:

2.1)	Teaching Assistant Knowledge – The T.A. was knowledgeable about the material.	Very Low or Never	Very High or Always	n=1	av.=9.00
2.2)	Teaching Assistant Concern – The T.A. was concerned about student learning.	Very Low or Never	Very High or Always	n=1	av.=9.00
2.3)	Organization – Section presentations were well prepared and organized.	Very Low or Never	Very High or Always	n=1	av.=9.00
2.4)	Scope – The teaching assistant expanded on course ideas.	Very Low or Never	Very High or Always	n=1	av.=9.00
2.5)	Interaction – Students felt welcome in seeking help in or outside of the class.	Very Low or Never	Very High or Always	n=1	av.=9.00
2.6)	Communication Skills – The teaching assistant had good communication skills.	Very Low or Never	Very High or Always	n=1	av.=9.00
2.7)	Value – The overall value of the sections justified your time and effort.	Very Low or Never	Very High or Always	n=1	av.=9.00
2.8)	Overall – What is your overall rating of the teaching assistant?	Very Low or Never	Very High or Always	n=1	av.=9.00

3. Your View of Section Characteristics:

3.1)	Difficulty (relative to other courses)	Low	High	n=1	av.=2.00
3.2)	Workload/pace was	Too Slow	Too Much	n=1	av.=2.00
3.3)	Integration of section with course was	Poor	Excellent	n=1	av.=3.00
3.4)	Texts, required readings	Poor	Excellent	n=1	av.=3.00
3.5)	Homework assignments	Poor	Excellent	n=1	av.=3.00
3.6)	Graded materials, examinations	Poor	Excellent	n=1	av.=3.00
3.7)	Lecture presentations	Poor	Excellent	n=1	av.=3.00
3.8)	Class discussions	Poor	Excellent	n=1	av.=3.00

DAY 2 - Color NOT-A-WHEEL

Objective

Use four colors - Alizarin Crimson, Cadmium Yellow, Ivory Black and Titanium White to explore color relationships in a fresh new format. We're ditching the traditional circle. You will build a color system that's not a wheel.



Sam Gilliam

PART 1: Gotta know the rules before you break the rules.

THE LIMITED PALETTE WHEEL

Make your own color wheel using:

- **Alizarin Crimson** (cool red)
- **Cadmium Yellow** (warm yellow)
- **Ivory Black**
- **Titanium White**



Johannes Itten's Color Wheel

What to do:

- Mix colors from this palette to create a full range of hues and values.
- Arrange your mixed colors into a **basic wheel** form (12 colors minimum).
- In your 12 colors be sure to include:
    - Primary mixes (Red + Yellow = Orange, etc.)
    - Tints (with white), Shades (with black), and muted tones
- Label your colors clearly.

PART 2: Break the circle

Choose a new structure to organize your colors and show relationships between them.



Homage to the square, Josef Albers

Choose one relationship to explore:

✅ **Complementary** (opposites)

✅ **Analogous** (neighbors)

✅ **Monochromatic** (one color, many values)

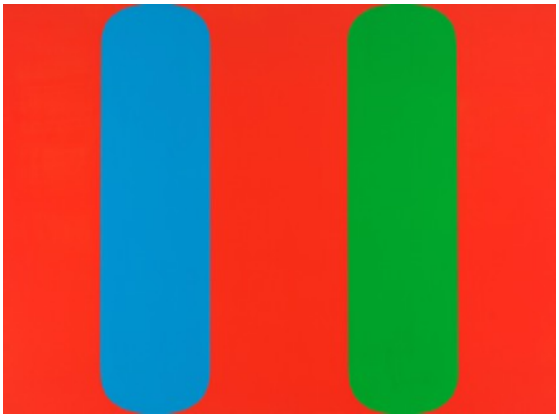
MAKE IT NOT A WHEEL

Use your chosen relationship to create a color system in a different form. Be inventive! It could be:



- A puzzle, chain, or web
- A straight or spiraling line
- An “impossible shape” (like a Penrose triangle)
- A folded paper form that shifts when opened
- A 3D shape (cube, pyramid, origami model)





Ellsworth Kelly

This is your chance to get sculptural, interactive, or abstract. Think of it this way - if you'd never seen a color wheel before what would it look like to you? For inspiration - look up Monument Valley, Color field painters, Josef and Anni Albers!

CRITIQUE GUIDE

1. *Description* – 4 things you observe
(Material, technique, subject matter, imagery, etc.)

2. *Association* – 3 things the work makes you think of/ reminds you of

3. *Meanings/Feelings* – what is the work about/what does it make you feel

4. *Your evaluation* – a useful suggestion, does anything need to be added/omitted? Make sure your comment has something to do with what you wrote above.

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Fundamentals of Painting

Summer 2025

Instructor: Roshini Agarwal
Contact/Email: roshiniagarwal@ucla.edu

Teaching Assistant: Rachel Jimenez

Required Text: Readings will be provided during class.

Course Description: The focus of this class is to equip students with a well-rounded knowledge of painting that is firmly based in technical, conceptual and historical grounds. It is to promote technical craftsmanship so students can conduct their own experimental research to innovate, develop and grow, not only their own practices, but also contribute to historic and contemporary material traditions. Within this growing history, students will discover the vast possibilities of bringing their ideas into existence. The class encourages individual curiosity and investigational efforts and fosters a communal sharing of ideas and resources. It will facilitate a deeper understanding of the physicality of paint, color and substrate, and deepen the student's relationship to their tools. It will explore the deeply referential, quotational and contextual global lineage of painting, one that goes all the way back to the earliest cave paintings in the world.

Learning Objectives: Students who have taken this course will:

- Aquire a knowledge of various painting materials, and a myriad of methods and techniques to use them.
- Develop research methods to test ideas and ways of making.
- Develop technical questions and curiosities which will lead their studio practice.
- Develop a studio practice that involves experimentation and play.
- Challenge and navigate the limits and possibilities of different materials, and hone their technical skills and knowledge of their craft.
- Apply knowledge acquired with confidence in their studio practice.
- Aquire the correct measures and precautions to conduct their research in a safe and healthy manner when dealing with materials and substances that are toxic or dangerous to work with.
- Aquire art historical context and knowledge of materials, techniques and

- Participate in community based learning and partake in critique-based and research-led conversation with their peers.

Studio Policy and Guidelines:

- For safety reasons, students must pay close attention during presentations and demonstrations and when using any challenging materials or processes. The use of laptops, phones, tablets etc. is not allowed during class.

- Headphones/Ear phones are to be removed during class discussions, demos and critiques.

- All students must be conscious of communal health and safety by being diligent in their individual material handling and ventilation. Students must clean up after themselves. Label all materials with name and date. Dispose of expired material appropriately. Dispose of oil rags and solvents in the appropriate bins as they are combustible.

- Students must help maintain a safe, productive and inclusive work environment for themselves and the rest of the class.

Course Expectations:

Students are expected to show up on time. In the event that a student is running late or is unable to make it to class, they must inform the instructor and/or the TA. Students are expected to make up for missed classes by showing interest, asking questions or conducting guided research.

Daily assignments that must be completed in a timely manner. There will be final critique at the end of Week 2 of work that was completed over the course of the class. Students will be expected to answer questions asked by their peers and participate in their peers' critiques. Attendance will be mandatory for critiques.

Descriptions of Assignments and Criteria for Assessment:

Daily Assignments: Homework assigned weekly must be done in a timely manner as it is necessary prep work for the upcoming in-class activities. They serve as individual research.

Final Critique: This critique will take place on the last week of this course. Students must be able to engage in discussion for 10-15 minutes. They must provide feedback and thoughts about material choice, technique, intention, image, art historical context and theory. Students whose work is being critiqued must choose between a cold reading of the work, or must provide context and specific questions they want answered during the duration of critique.

Attendance and participation is mandatory for receiving a grade.

Materials: Provided in class

Course Outline:

Date	Day plan	Class Plan/Weekly Learning Objectives	Assignments
Day 1 Monday (7/7/2025)	**Introductions** Review syllabus, set up Drawing exercise - still life, negative space, figure ground, line and tone. Painting lecture on still life *Break for Lunch* 1:15 - pick an object/ objects from still life closet Three 30 minute still lives Studio time 3:00 - Basic color mixing demo, limited color	• Learning proper technique, foundations of painting, paint mixing, developing palette. Importance of good technique. • Foundations of still life drawing/painting, change through iteration of form	Finish color wheel assignment Reading - Johannes Itten on color

Day 2 Tuesday (7/8/2025)	***Color*** 9:00 Watch Josef Albers David Zwirner video. Intro to color wheel assignment Painting lecture on Color 11:00 - VAL *Break for Lunch* Visit with Jason! Studio time 5:00 - intro to ongoing final Diptych Assignment **(due 7/17)**	• Learning use of limited colour palettes and fundamentals of colour theory.	Continue and finish color wheel assignment Reading - Amy Goldin on pattern https://www.artforum.com/features/patterns-grids-and-painting-209677/ Proposals for Diptych Final **due Fri (7/11/2025)**
Day 3 Wednesday (7/9/2025)	***Pattern*** 9:00 Reading discussion Review color wheels 10:15 Lecture on pattern Demo 1 - Tiling and methods of constructing pattern 11:00 Studio Time Break for Lunch 1:15 - VAL 2:30 - Work on Pattern painting, individual meetings 4:45 - Dinner 5:15 - Book binding! 6:30 - intro to artist presentation assignment, choose artist from list of artists provided/propose another (**due Mon 7/14**)	• Introduction to iteration through pattern • Practical use of developed limited palette • Gaining a contextual understanding of the use of pattern in the history of art, outside of a non-western canon	Artist Presentation - Present the work of a artist of your choosing, or from the list of artists provided. Prepare a presentation with a maximum of 5 images of work by your chosen artist, include the title, year it was made, medium and dimensions. You will have 4-6 minutes to talk about why you chose the artist, the pieces you chose and their practice. (**due Mon 7/14**)

Day 4 Thursday (10/7/2025)	***Museum Day!*** 9:00 - Review finished Pattern paintings 10:00 - *Break for lunch* 1:15 – Meet at Broad Lawn to prepare for Museum Trip 1:15 – 4:30 Museum Trip to Getty Center 4:30 – 5:30 Return from Getty, studio time. Intro to next assignment	• Learning to work with feedback provided by peers	Pick one work in the museum you'd like to steal from, imitate, redo or pay homage to. Bring to class a printout of an image of the painting/ artwork from the Getty website Also bring collage material Reading - tbd
Day 5 Friday (11/07/2025)	***Do it once, do it different*** 9:00 - Collage! 11:00 VALS *Break for Lunch* 1:15 *Do it once* Make a copy. Redraw the work you selected to steal from. 3:30 *Do it different* Redo the work you selected Studio time!	• Learning iterative painting practices. Developing artwork through iteration. • Difference between homage and appropriation. • Collage as iteration, re-contextualisation by form	Continue working on your interpretation of the museum piece Homework for weekend - Ideas for final projects, use paintings from previous projects ie. Still life, pattern and do it once/do it different. Propose a new composition or incorporate new material. Make sketchbook drawings to show instructor.
(Weekend)	Paint!	Paint!	Paint!

WEEK 2 **Day 6** **Monday** **(14/07/2025)**	***Critique?*** 9:00 Begin student presentations 11:00 VALS *Break for lunch* 1:15 Lecture - What is Critique? 1:45 Individual meetings, talk about final projects and ideas Studio time	• Acquire an understanding of critique, peer-to-peer feedback, constructive criticism • How to navigate critique?	Continue working on final projects
Day 7 **Tuesday** **(15/07/2025)**	***Studio*** 9:00 Painting slide lecture Studio time, continue work on final projects 11:00 Artist Talks by Instructors *Break for lunch* 1:15 Demos – installing and documenting artwork 2:00 Studio time, individual meetings with instructor/TA TA presentation?	• Acquiring disciplined studio practices • Introduction to undergraduate work (TA lecture)	Continue final projects, documentation of work Reading - tbd
Day 8 **Wednesday** **(16/07/2025)**	9:00 Reading discussion Studio time 11:00 - VALS *Break for lunch* *12:00 - 12:20 Optional info session about undergraduate admission at UCLA* 1:30 - Studio time, individual meetings 4:30 - 5:30 Group photo 5:15 – 7:00 studio time	• Acquiring disciplined studio practices	Work on final projects, prepare for Critique

Day 9 Thursday (17/07/2025)	9:00 – 12:00 Studio Time *Break for lunch* 1:15 – 3:30 Studio Time and Final Critique with Instructors 3:30 – 3:45 Snack Break 3:45 – 5:30 Continue Studio Time and Final Critique	• Acquiring disciplined studio practices • Understanding critique, peer-to-peer feedback and learning to construct feedback and request feedback that is productive.	Installation prep, finish painting
Day 10 Friday (18/07/2025)	***Install*** 9:00 – 12:00 Bring artwork to New Wight Gallery, install exhibition 12:00 – 1:15 Lunch 1:15 – 2:00 Pack artwork to be shipped home, final studio clean-up 2:00 – 3:30 Final Reception held at the New Wight Gallery - all students, parents / guardians, faculty, staff, and friends are welcome to attend! 3:30 – 4:00 De-install exhibition and retrieve all belongings from classrooms		

Resources:

Academic Integrity

UCLA is a community of scholars. In this community, all members including faculty, staff and students alike are responsible for maintaining standards of academic honesty. As a student and member of the University community, you are here to get an education and are, therefore, expected to demonstrate integrity in your academic endeavors. You are evaluated on your own merits. Cheating, plagiarism, collaborative work, multiple submissions without the permission of the professor, or other kinds of academic dishonesty are considered unacceptable behavior and will result in formal disciplinary proceedings usually resulting in suspension or dismissal.

Additional information can be found on the website for the Office of the Dean of Students: https://deanofstudents.ucla.edu/student-conduct-code

Remember: There are many alternatives to academic dishonesty!

- Seek out help – meet with your TA or Professor, ask if there is special tutoring available.
- Drop the course – can you take it next quarter when you might feel more prepared and less pressured?
- Ask for an extension – if you explain your situation to your TA or Professor, they might grant you an extended deadline.
- See a counsellor at Student Psychological Services, and/or your school, college or department – UCLA has many resources for students who are feeling the stresses of academic and personal pressures.

Accessibility

Students needing academic accommodations based on a disability should contact the Center for Accessible Education (CAE) at (310) 825-1501 or in person at Murphy Hall A255. When possible, students should contact the CAE within the first two weeks of the term as reasonable notice is needed to coordinate accommodations. For more information visit www.cae.ucla.edu.

Assault, Harassment, and Discrimination

Title IX prohibits gender discrimination, including sexual harassment, domestic and dating violence, sexual assault, and stalking. If you have experienced sexual harassment or sexual violence, you can receive confidential support and advocacy at the CARE Advocacy Office for Sexual and Gender-Based Violence, 1stFloor Wooden Center West, CAREadvocate@caps.ucla.edu, (310) 206-2465. In addition, Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS) provides confidential counseling to all students and can be reached 24/7 at (310) 825-0768. You can also report sexual violence or sexual harassment directly to the University's Title IX Coordinator, 2241 Murphy Hall, titleix@conet.ucla.edu, (310) 206-3417. Reports to law enforcement can be made to UCPD at (310) 825-1491. Please note, I am legally required to share information of this nature with the Title IX office.

Navigating Student Services

UCLA's new Student Affairs Guidebook gathers key resources for graduate and undergraduate students related to living and learning during these tumultuous times: https://www.studentaffairs.ucla.edu/guidebook. Students can always consult the Student Care Managers program website for information about supportive services, including information about confidential one-on-one consultation: http://www.studentincrisis.ucla.edu/Who-can-Help.

Basic Needs/Food Resources
If you find yourself having difficulty accessing meals and/or groceries, go to this link for information on a variety of on- and off- campus resources available to students: https://basicneeds.ucla.edu/.

LGBTQIA Resources
The UCLA LGBT Campus Resource Center (www.lgbt.ucla.edu) provides a range of services supporting intersectional identity development as well as fostering unity, wellness, and an open, safe, and inclusive environment. UCLA also has a range of policies and services especially relevant to transgender students here: www.lgbt.ucla.edu/Trans-At-UCLA.

Mental Health
As a student you may experience a range of issues that can cause barriers to learning, such as strained relationships, increased anxiety, alcohol/drug problems, depression, difficulty concentrating and/or lack of motivation. These mental health concerns or stressful events may lead to diminished academic performance or reduce a student's ability to participate in daily activities. UC offers services to assist you with addressing these and other concerns you may be experiencing. If you or someone you know are suffering from any of the aforementioned conditions, consider utilizing the confidential mental health services available on campus. I encourage you to reach out to the Counseling Center for support (www.counseling.ucla.edu and 310-825-0768, available 24/7). An on campus counselor or after-hours clinician is available 24/7.

Distinguished Teaching Assistant — Letter of Recommendation

This award celebrates Teaching Assistants who demonstrate a pattern of effective teaching that incorporates current best practices (e.g., student-centered learning, active learning, inclusive teaching), aims to inspire and challenge students, and supports the success of all students.

Name

Briefly describe how you know the nominee. (50 words max)

In a few sentences, describe a few ways in which the nominee inspired or challenged you or other students in the class. (200 words max)

Describe one or two things that the nominee did that you thought were particularly beneficial for your (or other students') learning or understanding of concepts. (200 words max)

Please share any additional reasons why you believe the nominee is an outstanding candidate for this award. (100 words max)

UCLA School of the
ARTS AND ARCHITECTURE : ART

February 4, 2026

I offer my unequivocal support for Roshini Agarwal's nomination for the Distinguished Teaching Award for Teaching Assistants. I observed Roshini's teaching firsthand in Advanced Painting during a two-week period when the professor of record took a temporary medical leave. In my role as Area Head, I checked in with the class during this interval and was immediately struck by the rigor, clarity, and depth of her instruction, as well as her sustained attentiveness to individual student needs. Under her guidance, each student received detailed written feedback on final project proposals that integrated historical and contemporary artist references, material and technical resources, and substantive engagement with each project's conceptual framework. This level of feedback reflected both her advanced disciplinary knowledge and her exceptional capacity to foster meaningful artistic and intellectual development.

In my capacity as Area Head, I have also had ongoing opportunities to review extensive evidence of Roshini's teaching effectiveness, including student evaluations, course materials, and the teaching artifacts submitted with this nomination. Taken together, this body of material reveals a pattern of sustained excellence.

Roshini's tenure as a teaching assistant in the Printmaking Studio was so impactful that she was specifically requested by the course instructor for a second appointment. During this period, she assumed significant responsibility for improving studio operations, initiating a comprehensive reorganization and cleaning effort that substantially enhanced workflow and functionality. She addressed a large cache of improperly stored powdered pigments by cataloging, organizing, and safely packaging the materials prior to donating them to an educational archive. This intervention improved studio safety while demonstrating an uncommon level of institutional care and responsible stewardship of shared resources.

In instructional settings, Roshini led demonstrations on image transfer techniques, paint mixing and color theory, surface preparation, and mounting paper on panel. Image transfer was a technically complex process she had not fully encountered prior to teaching, and she deliberately used this challenge as a teaching opportunity. By learning aspects of the technique alongside students, she modeled rigorous research and problem-solving practices. This approach reframed uncertainty as a productive component of artistic practice and encouraged students to take intellectual and creative risks.

During the School of Art's Summer Institute, which serves high school juniors and seniors—many of whom later apply to UCLA—Roshini demonstrated exceptional adaptability, initiative, and instructional leadership. She independently provided

supplemental materials, designed workshops that expanded beyond traditional painting instruction, and prepared structured slide lectures and critique templates that clarified expectations and strengthened student engagement. She also mentored students through portfolio development, wrote letters of recommendation, facilitated visiting artist lectures, and consistently fostered accountability, confidence, and enthusiasm in the classroom. Roshini also developed structured critique guides that significantly elevated the quality of student discussion. By the conclusion of the intensive program, students—many encountering critique for the first time—were able to lead extended, substantive conversations with minimal instructor intervention.

For these reasons, Roshini Agarwal stands out as an exceptional teaching assistant whose contributions exemplify the highest standards of teaching excellence, and she is fully deserving of the Distinguished Teaching Award for Teaching Assistants.

Respectfully,
Cosmo Whyte



Assistant Professor
Area Head of Painting
Department of Art
UCLA School of Arts and Architecture